

covered in the previous four steps – I began to think about planning ahead, and it really cemented the changes that I had begun to see in my feelings towards money, and also how I felt about myself. I found that I was no longer defining myself as someone who would never get on the property ladder, or never have savings, because I was entering a world where those things were looking more and more possible.

So, this final step is your opportunity to put some faith in your present self, and look out for your future self too. I really think that, once you've worked through the observations and exercises that follow, you'll start to feel a growing sense of wellbeing and positivity about your future, financial and otherwise.

Designing your lifestyle and setting goals

When I spoke to Anna Codrea-Rado about work and earning, and the impact of those factors on our self-worth, she mentioned the importance of 'lifestyle design', and the fact that we're neither taught how to manage our expectations of the kind of lifestyle we want, or to match our career and earning potential to the future that we see for ourselves. She is, of course, right. None of us are taught this kind of valuable information at school or even university, and if your parents don't teach you about the value of money and what living a certain lifestyle actually costs – or if, not uncommonly, they have their own hang-ups and issues around money – it can be